

Chapter 33 — "Spot the Pual" Passage Exercise (Weak Roots)

Gen 4 · Lev 7–8 · Num 3, 22 · Psa 72

Each numbered verb belongs to one of the stems you have already studied (Qal, Niphal, Hiphil, Hophal, Piel, or Pual). For each one, fill in: Pual? (Yes/No), Conjugation, PGN, Root, and Stem/Function. For each Pual form, also identify the weak-root type (I-■, I-■, III-■, or R2=■). The answer key begins on the page marked "Answer Key".

Passage A — Genesis Genealogies (Gen 4:18; 4:26; 46:22; 6:1)

4:18

וַעֲרַד יִלֵּד אֶת מְחֻיָּאֵל

"And Irad fathered Mehujael."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
1	יִלֵּד				

4:26

אָז הֵחֵל לְקַרֵּא בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה

"At that time people began to call upon the name of the LORD."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
2	הֵחֵל				

46:22

אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי רָחֵל אֲשֶׁר יָלַד לְיַעֲקֹב

"These are the sons of Rachel who were born to Jacob."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
3	יָלַד				

6:1

וַיֻּלְּדוּ لَهُם בָּנִים

"And sons were born to them."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
4	וַיֻּלְּדוּ				

Passage B — Leviticus 7:36; Numbers 3:9 (I-■ root ■■■)

I-■ Pual: unlike Qal Imperfect where ■ assimilates (■■■■■■■), in the Pual the ■ stays as R1 and takes Qibbuts. Dagesh Forte falls on R2 (■), not on an assimilated consonant.

Lev 7:36

אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה לָתֵת لَهُם

"...which the LORD commanded to give to them."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
5	צִוָּה				

Num 3:9

וַנִּתֵּן אֶת הַלְוִיִּם לְאַהֲרֹן וּלְבָנָיו נְתֻנִים נְתֻנִים הֵמָּה

"And you shall give the Levites to Aaron and his sons; they are given, given."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
6	וַנִּתֵּן				
7	נְתֻנִים				

Num 3:9b

נְתֻנִם לִי הֵמָּה מִתּוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

"They were given to me from among the people of Israel."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
8	נְתֻנִם				

Passage C — Leviticus 8:35; Numbers 22:6; Psalm 72:17 (III-■ and R2=■)

Lev 8:35

כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוִּיתִי אֲנִי כֵן צִוִּיתֶם

"As I was commanded, so you were commanded."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
9	צִוִּיתִי				
10	צִוִּיתֶם				

Num 22:6

כִּי יָדַעְתִּי אֶת אֲשֶׁר תְּבָרֵךְ מְבָרֵךְ וְאֲשֶׁר תָּאֵר יֹאֵר

"...for I know that he whom you bless is blessed, and he whom you curse is cursed."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
11	תְּבָרֵךְ				
12	מְבָרֵךְ				
13	יֹאֵר				

Psa 72:17

יְבָרֵךְ שְׁמוֹ לְעוֹלָם יִתְנַהֵל לִפְנֵי שֶׁמֶשׁ שְׁמוֹ

"May his name be blessed forever; may his name endure before the sun."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
14	יְבָרֵךְ				
15	יִתְנַהֵל				

Reflection Questions

1. Verb 3 (יָצַח, I-Pual Perfect) and verb 4 (נִצְחָה, Niphal Wayyiqtol) both come from יָצַח and both express passive meaning. What visual feature most immediately distinguishes the Pual from the Niphal in these I-Pual forms?
2. Verbs 7–8 (יָצַח / נִצְחָה, I-Pual) show that in the Pual, הָ stays as R1 and takes Qibbuts rather than assimilating as in the Qal Imperfect (יָצַח). What grammatical principle causes the different behavior between stems?
3. Verbs 9–10 (יָצַח / נִצְחָה, III-Pual) parallel verb 5 (יָצַח, Piel active). What single vowel under R1 most quickly identifies Piel vs. Pual? How does this i/u distinction work in the strong paradigm (יָצַח vs. יָצַח)?

Answer Key

Passages with correct answers shown in the green row below each verb.

Passage A — Genesis Genealogies (Gen 4:18; 4:26; 46:22; 6:1)

4:18

וַעֲרֵד יֵלֵד אֶת מְהוּיָאֵל

"And Irad fathered Mehujael."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
1	יָלַד				see ↓
✓	יָלַד	Perfect	3ms	יָלַד	NOT Pual — Qal: "fathered/begat"

4:26

אָז הוּחַל לְקַרְא בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה

"At that time people began to call upon the name of the LORD."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
2	הוּחַל				see ↓
✓	הוּחַל	Perfect	3ms	חָלַל	NOT Pual — Hophal: "was begun"; חָלַל

46:22

אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי רָחֵל אֲשֶׁר יָלַד לְיַעֲקֹב

"These are the sons of Rachel who were born to Jacob."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
3	יָלַד				see ↓
✓	יָלַד	Perfect	3ms	יָלַד	Passive — Pual; I- root: "was"

6:1

וַיֻּלְדוּ לָהֶם בָּנִים

"And sons were born to them."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
4	וַיֻּלְדוּ				see ↓
✓	וַיֻּלְדוּ	Wayyiqtol	3mp	יָלַד	NOT Pual — Niphal Wayyiqtol 3mp:

Passage B — Leviticus 7:36; Numbers 3:9 (I- root)

I- Pual: unlike Qal Imperfect where assimilates (), in the Pual the stays as R1 and takes Qibbuts. Dagesh Forte falls on R2 (), not on an assimilated consonant.

Lev 7:36

אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה לָתֵת לָהֶם

"...which the LORD commanded to give to them."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
5	צָוָה				see ↓
✓	צָוָה	Perfect	3ms	צָוָה	NOT Pual — Piel active: "commanded";

Num 3:9

וְנָתַתָּ אֶת הַלְוִיִּם לְאַהֲרֹן וּלְבָנָיו נְתֻנִים נְתֻנִים הֵמָּה

"And you shall give the Levites to Aaron and his sons; they are given, given."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
6	וְנָתַתָּ				see ↓
✓	וְנָתַתָּ	Weqatal	2ms	נָתַן	NOT Pual — Qal Weqatal: "and you
7	נְתֻנִים				see ↓
✓	נְתֻנִים	Participle	mp	נָתַן	Passive — Pual Ptc. mp; I- ■ root:

Num 3:9b

נְתֻנִים לִי הֵמָּה מִתּוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

"They were given to me from among the people of Israel."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
8	נְתֻנִים				see ↓
✓	נְתֻנִים	Perfect	3cp	נָתַן	Passive — Pual; I- ■ root: "were given";

Passage C — Leviticus 8:35; Numbers 22:6; Psalm 72:17 (III-■ and R2=■)

Lev 8:35

כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוִּיתִי אֹנִי כֵן צִוִּיתֶם

"As I was commanded, so you were commanded."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
9	צִוִּיתִי				see ↓
✓	צִוִּיתִי	Perfect	1cs	צָוָה	Passive — Pual; III- ■ root: "I was
10	צִוִּיתֶם				see ↓
✓	צִוִּיתֶם	Perfect	2mp	צָוָה	Passive — Pual; III- ■ root: "you were

Num 22:6

כִּי יָדַעְתִּי אֶת אִשָּׁר תְּבָרֵךְ מְבָרֵךְ וְאִשָּׁר תָּאֵר יוֹאֵר

"...for I know that he whom you bless is blessed, and he whom you curse is cursed."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
11	תְּבַרֵךְ				see ↓
✓	תְּבַרֵךְ	Imperfect	2ms	בֵּרַךְ	NOT Pual — Piel Intensive: "you bless"
12	מְבֹרָךְ				see ↓
✓	מְבֹרָךְ	Participle	ms	בֵּרַךְ	Passive — Pual Ptc. ms; R2=■ (weak):
13	יִאָּר				see ↓
✓	יִאָּר	Imperfect	3ms	אָרַךְ	NOT Pual — Hophal: "shall be cursed";

Psa 72:17

יְבָרֶכֶּה שְׁמוֹ לְעוֹלָם יִתְנַהֵל לִפְנֵי שֶׁמֶשׁ שְׁמוֹ

"May his name be blessed forever; may his name endure before the sun."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
14	יְבָרֶכֶּה				see ↓
✓	יְבָרֶכֶּה	Imperfect	3ms	בֵּרַךְ	Passive — Pual Impf.: "may his name be
15	יִתְנַהֵל				see ↓
✓	יִתְנַהֵל	Imperfect	3ms	נָהַל	NOT Pual — Hiithpael: "may